

ILS STAFF TRAINING | 2026

Client Hospital Admission & Staff Withdrawal Protocol

Supporting clients in the ER, stepping back at admission, and handling requests to stay



Support in the ER



Withdraw at admission



Redirect requests



Return only with
RCOC OK

The protocol in four parts



PART 1

In the ER: Support & Update

Stay with the client through triage and treatment. Keep your supervisor updated in real time.



PART 2

At Admission: Withdraw

When the client moves from the ER to an inpatient bed or unit, ILS services pause and you leave.



PART 3

Hospital Requests: Redirect

If hospital staff ask you to stay, explain the rule and point them to Social Work or the client's SC.



PART 4

RCOC Authorization

You may return only after RCOC authorizes it and your agency directs you.

Part 1: In the ER, stay and support



Active support

Accompany and assist your client throughout the entire ER triage and treatment process.



Continuous communication

Stay in contact with your ILS Supervisor or Agency Administration. Provide real-time status updates while the client is in the ER.

Status updates to give

- Arrival at the ER
- Triage and wait status
- Treatment and test updates
- Discharge or admission decision
- Transfer to an inpatient bed/unit

Examples only. Follow your supervisor's direction on how often to check in.

Part 2: Admission is the line

IN THE ER

ILS STAYS

- Accompany and assist through triage and treatment
- Give real-time updates to your supervisor or agency admin



ADMITTED

ILS WITHDRAWS

- ILS direct services temporarily cease
- Staff are withdrawn
- Hospital staff assume full primary care responsibility



Admission = the client is officially transferred out of the ER into an inpatient bed or unit.

What happens, step by step



Arrive at ER

Accompany the client.



Triage & treatment

Assist the client and give real-time updates.



Admission

Client moves to an inpatient bed or unit.



Withdraw

ILS services temporarily cease.
Staff are withdrawn.



Hospital care

Hospital staff assume full primary care.



ILS staffing during an inpatient stay is not permitted without specific prior authorization from RCOC (see Part 4).

Part 3: When the hospital asks you to stay

Nurses or medical staff may ask you to remain on-site. Respond professionally using these three steps, in order.



STEP 1

Inform & redirect

Explain that the client is a Regional Center participant and that ILS services automatically suspend upon hospital admission per regulatory guidelines.



STEP 2

Hospital Social Work

Advise the charge nurse or attending team to engage the hospital's Social Work department. Hospital social workers are typically familiar with Regional Center protocols.



STEP 3

Service Coordinator

If no hospital social worker is available, direct the nurse to contact the client's Regional Center Service Coordinator (SC).

What to say: sample wording



"My client is a Regional Center participant. ILS services automatically suspend when a client is admitted, per regulatory guidelines, so I'm not able to stay."



"Your Social Work department is usually familiar with Regional Center protocols. Could the charge nurse reach out to them?"



"If a social worker isn't available, please contact the client's Regional Center Service Coordinator."

Tips

- Stay calm, courteous, and brief
- You are not refusing care; you are following the protocol
- Don't agree to stay without authorization
- Keep your ILS Supervisor informed

Part 4: RCOC authorization for inpatient staffing

Applies only if the hospital maintains that the client needs dedicated ILS staff during the inpatient stay.

1

Contact On-Call

If the primary SC is unreachable, the hospital team contacts the RCOC Emergency On-Call number to request temporary staffing approval.

Hospital Staff

2

Agency Notification

If approval is granted, the RCOC On-Call Representative contacts the ILS Agency directly.

RCOC On-Call Staff

3

Re-engagement

ILS staff may redeploy to the hospital room only after direct verbal or written authorization is received from RCOC.

ILS Agency Admin

4

Written Documentation

If authorization occurs after business hours, formal written approval from the RCOC SC must be secured the next business day.

ILS Supervisor



A nurse's request is not authorization.

Authorization comes from RCOC to your ILS Agency. Go back to the hospital room only when Agency Administration tells you RCOC has approved it.



Hospital says “RCOC approved it”?

Wait. RCOC contacts the ILS Agency directly. Your Agency Admin will tell you if you can redeploy.



Authorized after hours?

Your ILS Supervisor secures formal written approval from the RCOC SC the next business day.

Check your understanding



SCENARIO A

Waiting for a bed

Your client has been in the ER for five hours. The doctor says they will be admitted, and they are waiting for a bed upstairs.

Do you stay or leave?



SCENARIO B

“Please stay overnight”

Your client has been moved to a room on the medical floor. The charge nurse asks you to stay overnight because the client is anxious.

What do you do?



SCENARIO C

“They said you can stay”

At 9:00 PM, after you have withdrawn, a nurse tells you, “I called the Regional Center and they said you can stay.”

Can you go back to the room?

Answers

SCENARIO A

STAY

The client is still in the ER. The threshold is transfer out of the ER into an inpatient bed or unit. Keep supporting the client and keep updating your supervisor.

SCENARIO B

WITHDRAW & REDIRECT

The client is admitted, so services cease. Explain politely, refer the nurse to hospital Social Work, and to the client's SC if no social worker is available.

SCENARIO C

NOT YET: WAIT

RCOC contacts your ILS Agency directly. Return only when Agency Admin confirms RCOC authorization. After hours, your supervisor gets written approval the next business day.

Remember the four moves



Support

Stay with the client in the ER and give real-time updates.



Withdraw

Leave when the client is admitted to an inpatient bed or unit.



Redirect

Refer requests to stay to Social Work or the client's SC.



Wait for RCOC

Return only when your agency confirms RCOC authorization.



Next steps: Keep your Quick Reference Guide on hand and sign your training attestation.